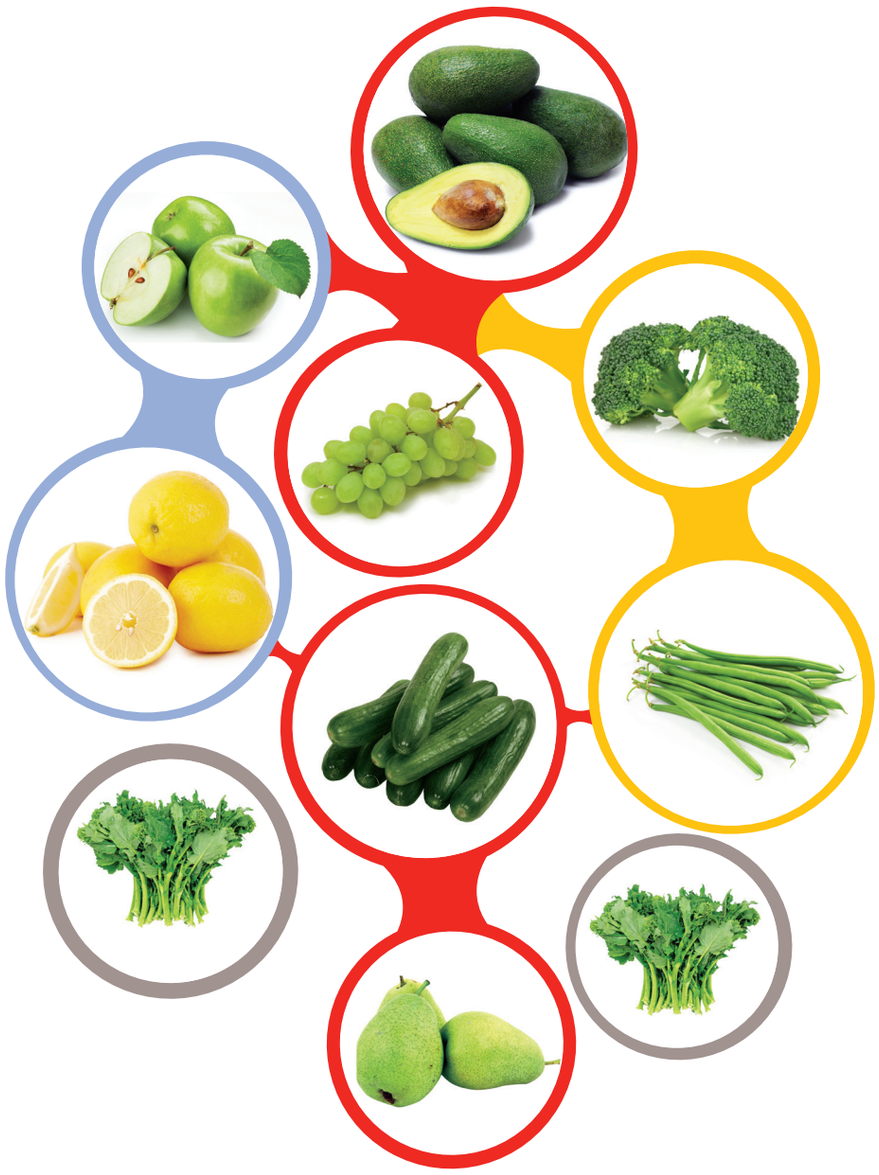


Figure 8.10 Sources of vitamin K

Functions:

- Vitamin K is essential for the synthesis of prothrombin, a substance necessary for blood clotting. That is why it is called as an anti-haemorrhagic vitamin.
- Vitamin K is needed to carboxylate specific glutamate residues of calcium binding proteins of bones, spleen and kidneys. This enhances the capacity of these proteins to deposit calcium in the tissues concerned.
- It plays a key role in the respiratory chain mechanism and oxidative phosphorylation.

Unit 8.indd 206 21-05-2018 15:11:41